

and off you go. BlueStacks is best used for running Android games and light productivity apps.

It can also run on Windows 8 in full-screen mode. This raises a potent question: Could efficient emulators in the future be the alternate solution to tedious dual booting?

The user interface of BlueStack is pretty good and feels just like using an Android phone right on your desktop.

It synchronises with your Google account so you can even log in to Google Play Store and download apps. The experience gets as close to stock Android as possible though it has been slightly modified for PC use.



The BlueStacks Play Bigger logo

System requirements

PC

- Windows 7/8/8.1/Vista/XP (32-bit)
- 2 GB RAM
- 9 GB HDD (for apps, games and their data)

Andy

Andy's system requirements are higher than that of BlueStack's but completely worth it. It requires about 3 GB of RAM and 20 GB of free disk space. Andy also implements VirtualBox, hence your machine should be capable of supporting virtualisation (easily determined by downloading a tool called 'CPU-Z').

Andy doesn't require a touchscreen, but supports it perfectly and if you have a touchscreen monitor you'll feel like you're operating an Android device. It also integrates itself with the system's hardware, that is, the wireless connectivity card, battery, etc.

The notifications dropdown appears as it normally does on an Android device. And for applications that need to work in portrait mode, Andy has a button in the system bar which will change the orientation with a single click. Andy also supports desktop push notifications and file-copying from PCs.



Notifications on Andy